

Whistleblowing Policy

Raising concerns about practice, safely and without fear

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE · Alternative Provision for Ages 5–25

ADOPTED POLICY

This policy has been formally adopted by L-Fit Pathways' co-directors and is in effect from the date shown below. Any section still shown in [square brackets and amber text] is organisation-specific detail that remains to be confirmed and inserted - it does not affect the rest of the policy's validity but should be completed as soon as possible.

Version: 1.0 (Adopted)

Date Adopted: 16 September 2026

Next Review Due: 16 September 2027 (or sooner following any legislative change or relevant incident)

1. Statement of Intent

L-Fit Pathways is committed to the highest standards of openness and accountability. Staff and volunteers have a duty to raise any concern about the conduct or practice of a colleague, contractor, or either Co-Director, and will be supported in doing so.

2. Legal Framework

- Public Interest Disclosure Act 1998
- Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026

3. What Can Be Reported

- A safeguarding concern about a colleague's conduct toward a young person
- Malpractice, dishonesty, or a breach of policy or legal obligation
- A risk to health and safety
- Any attempt to conceal any of the above

4. How to Raise a Concern

Concerns should be raised with a Designated Safeguarding Lead in the first instance. Where the concern relates to a DSL, it should be raised with the other Co-Director/DSL directly.

If a concern cannot appropriately be raised internally, it can be escalated externally to the NSPCC Whistleblowing Advice Line on 0800 028 0285 (email: help@nspcc.org.uk), or to the relevant Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO).

5. Protection for the Individual Raising a Concern

Any staff member or volunteer raising a genuine concern in good faith will not be penalised in any way, even if the concern is not subsequently upheld. Concerns can be raised confidentially; identity will be protected as far as possible, in line with what is required to investigate the concern properly.

6. What Happens Next

All concerns are taken seriously, acknowledged promptly, and investigated proportionately. Where a concern indicates immediate risk to a young person, it is treated as a safeguarding matter and escalated under our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy without delay.

7. Roles & Responsibilities

Both Co-Directors are jointly responsible for ensuring concerns raised under this policy are taken seriously and handled fairly.

8. Monitoring & Review

This policy is reviewed annually.

Policy adopted on: 16 September 2026 — Next review due: 16 September 2027